

Throughout ENGL 1A, I have refined my writing process, especially in the steps of prewriting, organizing, outlining, composing, revising, and editing. My previous work is shown in my Critical Essay on Keenan Norris's *A State of Extremes* (Point A). In comparing this to my recent work, The Film Essay Draft (Point B), I can see my process evolving and how my writing has become more intentional and focused, leading to more persuasive work.

My Critical Essay showed my ability to connect with a reading when I came into college. I wrote more directly to the point and never completed any prewriting or outlining. For example, I focused on one line from Norris's experiences in California. This was a good start, but it lacked a clear structure and a deeper analysis of the reading and prompt. My introduction was very straightforward and showed how I didn't plan for my following paragraphs and conclusion. In short, my early work was composed of fast and spontaneous writing rather than organized and thoughtful writing.

In Point B, my Film Essay Draft demonstrates my growth within the writing process. In contrast to Point A, I began with an outline (Film Outline Assignment), as well as taking in-depth notes about one major piece of media that connected to my social issue (Film Notes Assignment). This helped me map out my entire essay, as well as build an introduction paragraph and a conclusion paragraph that easily connect before starting my body paragraphs. This prewriting step gave me a roadmap, which led to my body paragraphs being more focused, in-depth, and clear to my thesis statement. I was also able to integrate scholarly and outside sources rather than relying on one or zero sources. Within this assignment, my body paragraphs and introduction/conclusion paragraphs were then peer-reviewed separately by two individuals. I took this feedback and went back to revise my entire essay to enhance it, as I may have overlooked some of the issues it had at first.

At the beginning of the year, I focused my writing mainly on my personal experiences rather than scholarly sources. However, now I am using outlines, taking multiple drafts, and building stronger arguments with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion that connects to the audience and is true to my original thesis statement. I began with watching my media choice, *The Insider* (1999), which connected to my social issue, and took notes about how the social issue was portrayed within this piece of media. Then I took these ideas and mixed them with my previous research and writing I had done on this social issue in order to take all of my most concrete and valuable pieces of data, evidence, and reasoning, to formulate an in-depth essay about this idea. This Film Essay Draft includes pieces of data and citations from scholarly sources, such as those from the MLK online library.

This growth has been valuable to me because it taught me that valuable writing comes not from the final product but through the process. Prewriting helps confine my original ideas into something that can be written about and analyzed. These steps of note-taking, outlining, revising, and even workshops with my classmates will continue to help my writing in future classes, professional writing, and personal projects.

In conclusion, ENGL 1A has shown me that good writing comes from a good process of writing. From my early writing about Norris's essay to my more recent Film Essay Draft about my social issue with supporting media and sources, I have shown my growth through my ability to take notes, outline, draft, revise, and peer-review to enhance my writing about a clear thesis and social issue.

Works Cited

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